

Lenovo's Honeycomb tablet?

According to a leaked company presentation, Lenovo is planning to come out with an Android 3.0 tablet sporting an IPS panel housing a Tegra 2 processor, in July

Going green in Amsterdam

Amsterdam has ordered around 125 electric vehicle charging stations to keep up with its target to eliminate internal combustion engine from its streets by 2040

HD-DTH test

Games button. It would have been great if the arrow buttons were of a distinct shape which is smaller than that of surrounding buttons.

Dish Active has around seven interactive services like Traffic Active (which is supposed to give traffic updates). This service was not working at our end and all we got was a MapMyIndia maps. Jobs Active allows you search for a job and contact the concerned person via a code number by logging onto the site or SMS the activation code. Cinema Active was quite good as it gives you the listings of movies around your location.

Sun Direct HD

Sun Direct HD is a DTH service that is quite popular in South India, which is the home of Sun TV network which owns this service. Just like Dish TV, you only get HD channels but it does not come with a digital video recorder.

The user interface is very simple and does not lag at all which we felt was a great plus point. It does not have any unnecessary graphics on the UI. The first channel you come across when you switch on the STB is the information channel which displays movie schedules, HD channels with their code numbers, and other offers on Sun Direct HD.

Most of the channels did not have any program information which was sad. There is no option to set reminders as well. Layout of the remote control is a bit uneasy though. It's great for someone who knows the channels by heart, but for most of us who channel surf, the button layout is annoying. You really have to bend your thumb to reach info and Exit buttons or to select the coloured buttons. The setup menu of the service looks quite attractive and is very easy to navigate through and make manipulations.

The Sun Direct HD watermark located on the left hand side of HD channels is distracting.

You can view photos or hear MP3 music off a USB drive by attaching it to the USB port behind which is a good feature. Now if only they had extended this functionality to videos as well, you would have a media player within the DTH box. Sun Direct HD is the only service which comes with a six month free subscription with its installation.

Verdict

Tata Sky+ HD was judged as the **Best Performer** for a host of parameters including its extremely responsive user interface. Quality of reception was flawless and it was

the only service that offered six proper HD channels along with seasonal HD channel like Set Max. Tata Sky+

HD scored the maximum in terms of features offered. Except for preview while surfing, it has all other features. Videocon is the only one offering 3D support, but unless there is 3D content like movies or TV shows being broadcast, that feature is quite useless.

Airtel Digital (HD) TV was judged as the **Best**

Brand	Phone	Website
Tata Sky	1860 425 6633	www.tatasky.com
Videocon	1800 881 1111	www.videocond2h.com www.reliancedigitaltv.com
Reliance	1800 200 9001	www.airteldigitaltv.in
Airtel	1800 102 8080	www.dishTV.com
Dish	1800 823 4929	www.sundirect.in
Sun	1800 200 7575	

functionality affected Tata Sky+ HD's tally. Videocon d2h came in second thanks to the well defined interface.

Videocon d2h 3D HD DVR was awarded the **Editor's Pick** for its consistent performance across all the four parameters against which it was tested. It stood second in terms of Performance. It also scored the second highest overall.



Sun Direct HD comes with a six month free subscription with installation but be prepared to pay a hefty price for owning all channels in the first year of operation

Buy thanks to its economical pricing for the content offered. It scored the most in the Ease of Use section, thanks to its user-friendly interface and ease of operations, but the user interface could have looked better. Tata Sky+ HD and Sun Direct HD have beautiful and simple interfaces. Absence of universal remote

Moreover, the 3D function makes your service future proof if you have a 3D TV. It lost out on the total cost of ownership factor as it does not offer any discount on the HD-DVR box like the other competitors. But we are hoping that with cut-throat competition, Videocon will have to cut costs somewhere.

As far as the best digital video recorder goes, Tata Sky+ HD was awarded the **Best Buy** thanks to the variety of recorder settings offered. The 500 GB hard disk which comes bundled with it, allows you to record more hours of SD and HD programs than the Videocon d2h and Reliance Digital HD DVR, for the same price point. **d**



Dish TV's claim of TruHD, as expected, was false. It does not have more than five true HD channels

GENRE-WISE SERVICE PROVIDER RECOMMENDATION	
English News	Tata Sky+HD
English Entertainment	Tata Sky+ HD or Reliance HD DVR
Infotainment	Airtel Digital TV (HD)
Music	Reliance HD DVR
English Movies	Tata Sky+ HD
Hindi GEC	Tata Sky+ HD or Videocon d2h or Dish TV TruHD
Sports Fanatic	Tata Sky+HD